

2nd Sep, 2026

Ethics & Social Responsibility

**Lecture
Three.**

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'lesson plan'

Group Presentation

- An application of the ethical theories learnt thus far
- And, maybe, an introduction into today's case studies

The Story of Kim Bok Dong

- Try to apply what we have learnt last week.

Environmental Ethics & Sustainability

- An overview to get us started

Case Studies

- Plastic vs. Paper Straws
- Boxed Water
- Cotton Tote Bags

Some Netflix

- The Good Place

GROUP PRESENTATION

and q&a.

APPLY THE ETHICAL THEORIES

the story of Kim Bok Dong

the story of Kim Bok-Dong

Life of a Comfort Woman: The Story of Kim Bok-Dong (RIP)

**apply the ethical theories we have learnt
and consider the actions of those involved**

Were the actions of the Japanese government ethical?

What about the actions of the Japanese soldiers?

Is it ethical for Kim Bok-Dong to question the actions of her government?

Any other thoughts?

ENVIRONMENTAL ETHICS

and sustainability.

Environmental Ethics & Sustainability

because, humans (and our activities) have a major (adverse) impact on the environment.

because, even when we try to do better, we seem to be creating more problems.

how and why is ethics relevant?

CASE STUDIES

let's talk about straws.

Think,

**what's the big
deal with plastic
straws?**

Plastic straws linger for over 300 years.

But, paper or bioplastic straws aren't a perfect solution.

- Plastic packaging poses an even greater problem for the environment.

So, what is the right thing to do?

CASE STUDIES

have you drank water from a box?

why “boxed” water?

Recyclable

printed on all drink cartons
is the recycle logo that we
are so familiar with

(yet, most are not familiar
with how to recycle)

NOT Plastic

plastic has become, in many
ways, “public enemy number
1”

in the world of sustainability
and environmentalism.

or, so we have been told.

let's see what you think

Do you think “boxed” water (or other drinks packaged in cartons) are more environmentally friendly?

Do you choose drinks packaged in cartons over those in plastic bottles because you think (consciously or unconsciously) that it is “better”?

*well,
here's the problem with
cartons.*

They are made up of various materials and are thereby harder to recycle.

They cannot be 100% recycled.

Very few facilities have the technology required to recycle cartons.

Even when recycled, the materials are often "downcycled" or turned into unrecyclable products.

what ethical dilemmas can you identify from this case study?

Should businesses continue using such cartons?

Is it more ethical to use cartons than plastic?

Is it ethical to label the cartons “recyclable”?

CASE STUDIES

how many tote bags do you have?

let's do a little poll.

Have you received a reusable tote bag?

Have you gifted a reusable tote bag?

How many reusable tote bags do you own?

Have you used all of your reusable tote bags?

Have you used any reusable tote bag at least 100 times?

let's look at some statistics

An *organic* cotton tote bag must be used 20,000 times to offset its overall impact of production.

Only 15% of 30 million tons of cotton produced every year make it to depositories that will recycle textiles.

10% to 15% of "recycled" tote bags are wasted because logos thereon are printed with PVC-based dyes, and are chemically difficult to break down.

but, remember

*the move towards reusable tote bags was with
positive and good intentions.*

or, was it?

**were businesses virtuous and acting with morality
when introducing reusable tote bags? or, was this
yet another marketing/branding tool?**

SO,

what is the ethical case for and against
reusable tote bags?

SOME NETFLIX

and heading to “The Good Place”.

think about this,

can we truly achieve a sustainable and
environmentally ethical lifestyle?

what is an environmentally ethical lifestyle?

now, on to The Good Place

Many Parts Make A Whole

Part One

Part Two

Part Three

Part Four

can we actually achieve truly sustainable living?

Applying the ethical theories you have learnt in class,

what would living in an environmentally ethical manner entail?

what would each theorist say about living sustainably and in an ethical manner?

which ethical theory do you subscribe to, with respect to this area?

Thank
You.

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What am I to do
with all my
tote bags
?!

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